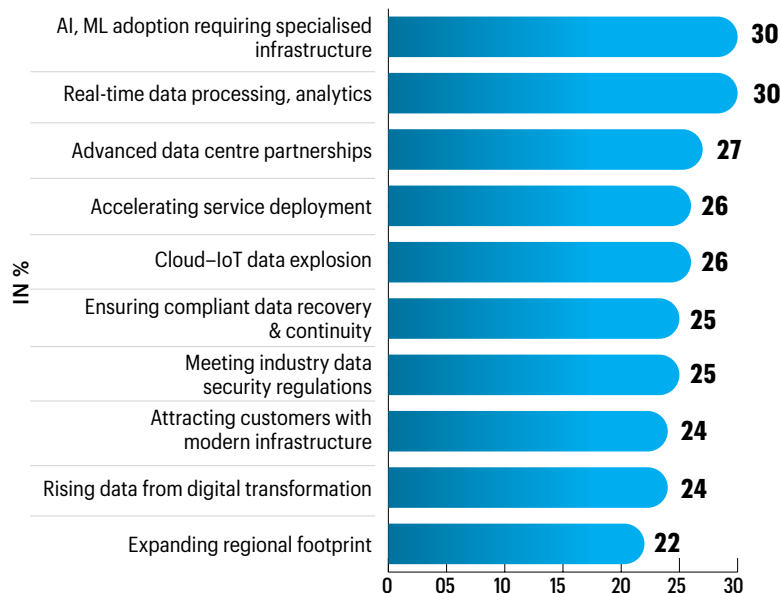


KEY TRIGGERS FOR DATA CENTRE BOOM



SOURCE IDC'S ASIA PACIFIC STATE OF DATA CENTER INFRASTRUCTURE SURVEY

capacity data centres with higher rack power density," he says.

This is how it works: AI workloads typically require a high-density GPU environment, which needs more power and advanced cooling techniques as compared to traditional workloads. According to the 2026 Global Data Outlook report by JLL, AI workloads, both inferencing and training, are projected to grow to 50% of the overall data centre workload by 2030, from 23% in 2025, even as overall workloads grow from 103 GW to 200 GW.

The Indian market is dominated by colocation data centre providers like Yotta, Sify Technologies, NTT, Equinix and others, where the operator provides a shared infrastructure space with the companies bearing the responsibility of sourcing their own

computing equipment. "AI service providers are looking at India as a big market, and they are shifting a lot of workloads into this country," says Manoj Paul, MD, Equinix India, adding the company is focused on tapping the growing demand for AI inferencing.

NEW USE CASES DRIVING DEMAND

In addition to the growth in AI-driven applications, there's also a change in how customers are using data centres. More enterprises are storing data on the cloud and there's a huge increase in industrial IoT applications which are processed and stored in these data centres. A mix of cloud computing, hyperscale deployments and increase in high-performance computing workloads are adding to the demand. "Data centres are

increasingly supporting latency sensitive applications such as real time analytics, digital services, and industry specific AI use cases across banking, manufacturing, healthcare, and media. Together, these use cases are shifting data centres from static infrastructure environments to highly dynamic, performance-driven platforms that are central to customers' digital and AI strategies," says Alok Bajpai, Managing Director, India, NTT Global Data Centers.

Enterprises are also placing new demands on their co-location partners to cater to their changing business dynamics, like flexibility in how much space they require and seamless interconnectivity among different service providers. All these factors are translating into a change in infrastructure requirements with the need for larger facilities with higher power and cooling requirements.

Sify Technologies, which already runs 14 data centres in India, is planning another 11 facilities across the country. "These upcoming centres are being built to support AI-ready infrastructure and edge deployments, ensuring we stay aligned with the next phase of digital growth," says Roopesh Kumar, Head—Data Center Projects at Sify Technologies.

While existing data centres can be retrofitted, industry experts say that's not necessary since we are at an early stage. However, all new projects are being designed while being cognisant of these changing requirements. "The shift towards AI-driven workloads is directly shaping our future plans—from how we select sites and secure power, to how we phase development and invest in long-term capacity," says Bajpai. The company is re-engineering existing platforms to support AI-